

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Chickpea Saag

with Feta, Basmati Rice, and Fried Almonds

A traditional Indian saag is made of creamed spinach or leafy greens and is often served with paneer—a type of firm, non-melting cheese. Tonight, we're swapping the paneer with feta for a similar texture, but slightly salty, tangy flavor. The rich saag sauce is blended with aromatic spices, like cardamom and coriander, and served over fluffy basmati rice to soak it up.

35–45 minutes 820 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 1 cup basmati rice
- 1 lime
- 12 ounces baby spinach
- 2 cans chickpeas
- 14 ounces feta cheese
- 2 yellow onions
- 3 cloves garlic
- ½ ounce ginger
- 1 teaspoon ground cardamom
- 2 teaspoons ground coriander
- 2 tablespoons slivered almonds
- 1 packet silk chile powder

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
6" small pot with lid
12" large high-sided pan
blender or food processor
8" small pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

The chickpea cooking liquid, also called aquafaba, is frequently discarded, but don't waste it! It's often used for its ability to thicken; here, we're using it as a substitute for water to add richness to the saag. It's easiest to reserve in a liquid measuring cup, if you have one.

No blender? Add sautéed aromatics, spinach, and reserved chickpea liquid to pan with chickpeas and feta in Step 5 and cook until liquid is reduced and spinach is wilted, 2–3 minutes.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

1930-7665-4P



1. Make basmati rice

In a small pot, combine **rice**, **1½ cups water**, and **½ teaspoon salt** and bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 10–12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Fluff **rice** with a fork, then cover again to keep warm until ready to serve.



2. Prepare ingredients

While rice cooks, rinse all produce. Halve **lime**. Pat **spinach** dry with paper towel and roughly chop. Reserve **⅔ cup chickpea liquid**, then drain and rinse **chickpeas** (see recipe tip). Cut **feta** into 1-inch cubes (try to avoid crumbling the feta so the pieces stay intact). Peel **onions** and cut into small dice. Mince **garlic**. Trim and discard skin of **ginger** and mince.



3. Sauté aromatics

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large high-sided pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **onion** and sauté until soft and translucent, about 5 minutes. Stir in **cardamom**, **coriander**, **garlic**, and **ginger**. Cook, stirring, until fragrant, 1–2 minutes more. Remove pan from heat and set aside.



4. Make saag sauce

In a blender or food processor, combine **sautéed aromatics**, **spinach**, and **reserved chickpea liquid**. Blend until smooth (see recipe tip). Meanwhile, return pan from aromatics to medium-high heat and add **1 teaspoon olive oil**. When oil is shimmering, add **chickpeas** and cook, stirring, until warmed through, 3–4 minutes. Remove pan from heat.



5. Finish saag and fry almonds

Heat **2 tablespoons olive oil** and **¼ teaspoon salt** in a small pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **almonds**. Fry, stirring frequently, until light golden, 2–3 minutes. Remove from heat. Return pan with chickpeas to medium-high heat, then add **feta** and **saag sauce**. Cook, stirring gently, until warmed, 1 minute. Remove from heat and season with **juice of 1 lime** and **1¼ teaspoons salt**.



6. Plate chickpea saag

Divide **basmati rice** among shallow serving bowls. Spoon **feta and chickpea saag** over rice. Top with **fried almonds**, drizzling over oil from pan, then sprinkle with **silk chile powder** (it's a bit spicy, so skip or use half for less heat). Enjoy!

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